# Nexus Release Notes and Version Compatibility Reference

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**Summary.** Reference for Northstar Nexus Platform versions 4.2 LTS, 4.3, 5.0 LTS and 5.1. Covers release dates, support end dates, upgrade paths, notable changes per release, compatibility of connectors and APIs, and how Support should answer version questions.

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## 1. Purpose and Scope

This reference gives Customer Success, Support and Engineering staff one authoritative place to check which Northstar Nexus Platform versions exist, how long each is supported, which upgrade paths are allowed, and what changed in each release. It is used when answering customer questions in NorthAssist, preparing upgrade plans, and deciding whether a reported problem is in a supported version.

The document covers the Nexus Platform (Workspaces, Pipelines, Connectors, Webhooks), Nexus Connect (API gateway and prebuilt connectors) and the Nexus Insight analytics add-on. It does not cover support response targets (see CS-003), the troubleshooting code catalogue (see CS-002) or the internal release process (see ENG-006 and ENG-002). The version tables are refreshed on each release by the Product Manager, Nexus Platform, without issuing a new document version; the tables below reflect the state after the 5.1 release.

Support staff must quote dates from this reference rather than from memory or from old customer emails. If a customer quotes a different date, check this document first and then raise a question to the Product Manager, Nexus Platform.

## 2. Definitions

- **LTS (Long Term Support)**: a release that receives security fixes and defect fixes for 24 months from its release date.
- **Non-LTS**: a release that receives fixes for 12 months from its release date.
- **Supported**: the version is within its support window. Support may open defects against it and Engineering may issue patches.
- **End of support (EOS)**: the last day of the support window. After that date Support provides only upgrade guidance, not fixes.

- **Direct upgrade**: moving from one version to another in a single upgrade operation without an intermediate version.
- **Workspace**: the tenant-level container for Pipelines, Connectors and Webhooks.
- **Pipeline**: an ordered set of steps that moves and transforms data between Connectors.
- **Connector**: a prebuilt or custom integration to an external system, delivered through Nexus Connect.
- **Webhook**: an outbound HTTP callback fired on a Pipeline or Workspace event.
- **Patch release**: a PATCH-level semantic version change, for example 5.0.3 to 5.0.4, containing fixes only.

## 3. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Product Manager, Nexus Platform**: owns this reference, publishes release notes, and confirms support dates.
- **Support Engineers (Level 1)**: check the customer's version against this reference at the start of every ticket and record the version in NorthAssist.
- **Support Leads (Level 2)**: decide whether a ticket on an unsupported version is handled as an upgrade-guidance case.
- **Engineering on-call manager**: confirms whether a defect is fixed in a later patch of the same version line.
- **Customer Success Managers (CSMs)**: use the upgrade paths in section 5 to plan customer upgrades ahead of end of support, and raise the topic in business reviews.
- **Release Manager (Engineering)**: supplies release dates and build identifiers; releases follow the weekly release train described in ENG-006.

## 4. Version Overview

### 4.1 Support window table

| Version | Type | Release date | Support ends | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4.2 LTS | LTS | 2025-01-20 | 2027-01-20 | Supported |
| 4.3 | Non-LTS | 2025-06-03 | 2026-06-03 | Support ended |
| 5.0 LTS | LTS | 2026-02-10 | 2028-02-10 | Supported |
| 5.1 | Non-LTS | 2026-08-18 | 2027-08-18 | Supported |

Rules that follow from the table:

- LTS releases have a 24-month window and non-LTS releases have a 12-month window, counted from the release date.
- Version 4.3 is out of support. Support must not promise fixes for 4.3 and must steer 4.3 customers to an upgrade.
- Version 4.2 LTS remains supported until 2027-01-20, and customers on it should start planning a move to 5.0 LTS well before that date.
- A customer on 5.1 must expect to move again within 12 months, because 5.1 is non-LTS and support ends on 2027-08-18. Customers who want the longest stable period should choose 5.0 LTS.

### 4.2 Choosing between LTS and non-LTS

Recommend an LTS release to customers who run regulated, audited or heavily integrated Workspaces, who change infrequently, or who have long change-approval cycles. Recommend a non-LTS release to customers who want new features early and can upgrade at least once a year. The choice is a customer decision; Support and CSMs describe the trade-off and record the customer's choice in NorthAssist.

Example: A logistics customer in Pune runs 4.2 LTS with 14 Pipelines and a two-month internal change freeze each year. The CSM should recommend 5.0 LTS rather than 5.1, because 5.1 would give them a support window of only 12 months and they typically need six months to plan a change.

# 5. Upgrade Paths

## 5.1 Allowed paths

| From | To | Allowed directly? | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 4.2 LTS | 5.0 LTS | Yes | Standard LTS to LTS path |
| 4.2 LTS | 5.1 | No | Go through 5.0 LTS first |
| 4.3 | 5.0 LTS | Yes | Allowed; 4.3 is out of support |
| 4.3 | 5.1 | Yes | Allowed |
| 5.0 LTS | 5.1 | Yes | Minor upgrade |
| 5.1 | 5.0 LTS | No | Downgrades are not supported; restore from backup instead |

Key rules:

1 A customer on 4.2 LTS can upgrade directly to 5.0 LTS.
2 A customer on 4.3 must reach the 5.x line by going to 5.0 LTS or by going to 5.1. The direct move from 4.3 to 5.1 is supported.
3 A customer on 4.2 LTS who wants 5.1 must first complete the upgrade to 5.0 LTS and then upgrade to 5.1.
4 Downgrades are not supported. If an upgrade fails, the customer is restored from the pre-upgrade backup and the upgrade is retried after the cause is fixed.

## 5.2 Upgrade preparation checklist

Before any upgrade, the CSM or Support Lead must confirm with the customer that:

1 The current version and build are recorded in NorthAssist.
2 A full export of the Workspace configuration (Pipelines, Connectors, Webhooks) exists and has been verified.
3 Every custom Connector has been tested against the target version in a non-production Workspace.
4 Webhook receivers have been checked for any changed payload fields listed in section 6.
5 The upgrade window avoids the customer's own peak processing hours and, for hosted customers, is communicated at least 7 days ahead.

6 A rollback plan exists, which for hosted customers means the pre-upgrade snapshot and for self-managed customers means a database backup plus the previous installer.

### 5.3 Worked upgrade examples

Example 1: A manufacturing customer in Chennai runs 4.3. Support ended on 2026-06-03, so the CSM opens an upgrade plan. The customer wants the longest support window, so the plan targets 5.0 LTS, supported until 2028-02-10. The move is a permitted direct path.

Example 2: A fintech customer in Mumbai runs 4.2 LTS and asks to jump to 5.1 to get the newest features. The Support Lead explains that a direct 4.2 to 5.1 upgrade is not supported. The customer first upgrades to 5.0 LTS, validates Pipelines for a week, and then upgrades to 5.1.

Example 3: A customer on 5.1 asks to go back to 5.0 LTS after seeing a behaviour change. Downgrade is not supported, so Support offers a restore of the pre-upgrade backup, with the understanding that any data processed since the upgrade will need to be replayed.

## 6. Release Notes by Version

### 6.1 Version 4.2 LTS

Released 2025-01-20. This was the first LTS line in the 4.x family. Notable characteristics:

- Introduced consolidated Workspace settings, where API tokens are rotated.
- Standardised the problem-details error format for the public API.
- Introduced cursor pagination as the default, with a default page size of 50 and a maximum of 200.
- Shipped the first set of prebuilt Connectors in Nexus Connect, with the default connector timeout of 30 seconds.
- Added Webhook retry with exponential backoff.

Known limitations: the Nexus Insight add-on has a limited set of dashboards on 4.2, and some newer Connector versions are not available on 4.2 because they depend on 5.x features.

### 6.2 Version 4.3

Released 2025-06-03. Non-LTS. Support ended 2026-06-03. Notable characteristics:

- Added Pipeline run history search.
- Added improved schema validation in Pipelines, which surfaces NX-4003 earlier when field mappings do not match.
- Added configurable connector timeouts up to 120 seconds.
- Added extended audit trails for Workspace changes.

Because support has ended, no new fixes are produced for 4.3. A ticket from a 4.3 customer is handled as upgrade guidance: Support may still help the customer collect diagnostics, but the resolution path is to upgrade.

### 6.3 Version 5.0 LTS

Released 2026-02-10. Support until 2028-02-10. Notable characteristics:

- New Pipeline engine with improved throughput and lower latency for high-volume Pipelines.
- Redesigned Workspace administration console with role-based access for Workspace admins.
- Expanded prebuilt Connector library in Nexus Connect.
- Nexus Insight add-on gains additional dashboards and scheduled report delivery.

- Webhook signing is enabled by default for new Workspaces.
- Public API remains under the /v1/ URL version; any removal of an existing API behaviour follows the deprecation rules in section 7.

Upgrade note: customers moving from 4.2 LTS should expect a one-time re-validation of custom Connectors, because the Connector interface was extended in 5.0.

### 6.4 Version 5.1

Released 2026-08-18. Non-LTS. Support until 2027-08-18. Notable characteristics:

- Pipeline templates for common integration scenarios.
- Further improvements to run history and diagnostics, including clearer request IDs in error responses.
- Additional Connectors in Nexus Connect.
- Performance refinements to the Nexus Insight add-on.

Upgrade note: 5.1 can be reached directly from 4.3 or from 5.0 LTS. It cannot be reached directly from 4.2 LTS.

## 7. Compatibility Reference

### 7.1 API compatibility

- The public API uses URL versioning (/v1/) on all supported Nexus versions. A change in the Nexus Platform version is not by itself a change in the API URL version.
- Breaking API changes are only introduced in a new major API version. A public API behaviour is deprecated with at least 12 months notice and a Sunset header before removal.
- Default rate limit is 1,000 requests per minute per tenant on all supported versions; exceeding it returns HTTP 429 with a Retry-After header and, in the Nexus error catalogue, code NX-3010.
- Service access uses OAuth 2.0 client credentials. An expired or invalid API token returns NX-1001; the fix is to rotate the token in Workspace settings.
- The default request timeout is 30 seconds.

### 7.2 Connector compatibility

| Item | 4.2 LTS | 4.3 | 5.0 LTS | 5.1 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Custom Connectors from 4.x | Native | Native | Re-validate | Re-validate |
| New Connectors released after 5.0 | Not available | Not available | Available | Available |
| Default connector timeout | 30 seconds | 30 seconds | 30 seconds | 30 seconds |
| Maximum configurable timeout | 120 seconds | 120 seconds | 120 seconds | 120 seconds |

Notes:

- NX-2004 (connector timeout) behaves the same on all versions. The default timeout is 30 seconds and may be raised up to 120 seconds after checking endpoint latency.
- NX-4003 (schema mismatch in a Pipeline) is most often seen after a Connector version change. Re-map the fields and check the Connector version before opening an Engineering ticket.
- When a customer upgrades from 4.x to 5.x, custom Connectors must be re-validated. Support should ask for the Connector name and version and the Nexus version before and after the upgrade.

### 7.3 Nexus Insight compatibility

The Nexus Insight add-on is released with each Nexus Platform version. Dashboards created on an older version are preserved on upgrade. Features added in a later version are not available to customers on an earlier version, so a customer asking for a dashboard that only exists in 5.0 LTS or later must be told the upgrade is a prerequisite.

### 7.4 Webhook compatibility

Webhook payloads are backwards compatible within a major version. Where a field is added, existing receivers should ignore unknown fields. Webhook signing is enabled by default for new Workspaces on 5.0 LTS and later; existing Workspaces keep their previous setting after upgrade until the Workspace admin changes it.

## 8. Handling Version Questions in Tickets

### 8.1 Required information

Every ticket about product behaviour must include the Nexus version, as required by the standard ticket template in CS-002. Version information must be recorded together with tenant ID, Workspace name, request ID, timestamp with timezone, steps to reproduce and an impact statement. A ticket missing the Nexus version must be returned to the customer for it before triage is completed, unless the issue is P1, in which case Support collects the version from the Workspace settings page while the customer is on the call.

### 8.2 Decision rules

1 If the customer's version is supported (4.2 LTS, 5.0 LTS or 5.1), proceed with normal troubleshooting under CS-003 and CS-007.
2 If the customer's version is 4.3, tell the customer that support has ended, help gather diagnostics, and open an upgrade-guidance task for the CSM. Do not promise a fix.
3 If the defect is reproduced on the latest patch of a supported version line, Engineering opens a defect. If it is already fixed in a later patch, the resolution is to apply that patch.
4 If a customer asks for a feature that exists only in a later version, Support must state the version that has it and the allowed upgrade path from the customer's current version.
5 Support must never promise a delivery date for a fix or release. Delivery dates require Engineering confirmation, and customer messages use approved templates.

### 8.3 Unsupported version, P1 incident

An unsupported version does not remove the obligation to respond to a production-down report. For a P1 on 4.3, Support acknowledges within the customer's tier target, restores service where possible by a configuration workaround or a restore, and then records that the permanent resolution is an upgrade. The Support Lead decides on the level of Engineering involvement, and the case is recorded in NorthAssist with the reason code for an unsupported version.

Example: A Premier customer on 4.3 reports that Pipelines stop after a Connector timeout. Support applies the documented timeout change (NX-2004 guidance, raising the timeout from 30 to 60 seconds), service resumes, and the CSM schedules the upgrade to 5.0 LTS since 4.3 is no longer supported.

## 9. Planning Customer Upgrades

### 9.1 Timing

CSMs must review every customer's version at least once per quarter. The following triggers apply:

- **12 months before EOS** for LTS versions: raise the upgrade topic in the next business review.
- **6 months before EOS**: agree a target version and a rough upgrade window.
- **90 days before EOS**: confirm the upgrade date and the customer's test plan.
- **After EOS**: treat the account as a risk item; it is recorded in the customer health review under commercial and product risk.

For version 4.2 LTS, with support ending on 2027-01-20, the 6-month point falls in July 2026 and the 90-day point falls in October 2026.

### 9.2 Customer communication

Upgrade notices must be plain and factual, in English or Hindi on request for India customers, and must not include internal system names or personal data. Notices state the current version, the end-of-support date, the recommended target version, and the upgrade path. They must not promise features or dates that Engineering has not confirmed.

### 9.3 Edge cases

- A customer running a mix of Workspaces on different versions must be treated Workspace by Workspace; each Workspace follows the paths in section 5.
- A customer who declines to upgrade before EOS must be told in writing that Support will provide upgrade guidance only. The decision is recorded in NorthAssist and shared with the CSM and Support Lead.
- A customer on an LTS version that is approaching EOS and who has an active P1 or P2 ticket should have the upgrade scheduled after the incident is resolved, not during it.

## 10. Frequently Asked Questions

**Is 4.3 still supported?** No. Support for 4.3 ended on 2026-06-03.

**How long is 5.0 LTS supported?** For 24 months from its release on 2026-02-10, which means until 2028-02-10.

**Can a 4.2 LTS customer go straight to 5.1?** No. The customer must upgrade to 5.0 LTS first.

**Can a 4.3 customer go straight to 5.1?** Yes, the direct path is supported, as is the path to 5.0 LTS.

**What is the difference between LTS and non-LTS?** LTS releases have 24 months of support and non-LTS releases have 12 months.

**Does the rate limit change between versions?** No. The default is 1,000 requests per minute per tenant on all supported versions.

## 11. Related Documents

- CS-002 for the troubleshooting code catalogue and the standard ticket template.
- ENG-006 for the release train, rollout stages and rollback rules that govern how releases reach production.
- ENG-002 for API standards, versioning and deprecation rules.
- CS-003 for support response and escalation targets by tier.

## 12. Revision History

| Version | Effective date | Change |
|---|---|---|
| 1.0 | 2025-02-03 | First release covering 4.2 LTS and early 4.3 notes |
| 2.0 | 2026-02-08 | Added 5.0 LTS, upgrade path rules and compatibility tables |